

But you should never put a space before the parentheses when invoking. It's confusing, broken, and looks too similar to a function being invoked with a callback argument:



Finally, a note on subsequent function calls.

Add parentheses for subsequent function calls

Suppose you have three functions, `x`, `y` and `z`, and you invoke them as follows:

```
x y z 4
```

By glancing at it, in what order do you think they're being invoked? Adding parentheses shows you:

```
x(y(z(2)))
```

Even if you got it right this time, it's almost guaranteed that unparenthesized function calls will catch you out in CoffeeScript at least once sometime in the future. To avoid the problem, it's best to add some parentheses any time the expression might be ambiguous. Remember, you shouldn't have to refer to the generated JavaScript to understand what a CoffeeScript program is supposed to do. If it looks ambiguous, then you need to rewrite it. As figure 7.2 shows, you should stick to common language idioms, but be mindful of anything that might be ambiguous to you later, to the compiler, or to other people who have to work on your program.

Figure 7.2. Stick to common language patterns, but be careful of ambiguity.